Rent-Roll Truth Check: RV Edition

Property: _____ **Date:** _____

Part D: Prove the numbers.

Takes in: reservation export, deposits, tax filings.

Hands to: AS-24 (stabilized revenue), AS-19 (the decision).

A booking report is a list of intentions. Deposits and platform payouts are behavior. Rate sheets and stay agreements are terms. Tax filings and the power meter cannot be edited by the seller. A month is verified only when the booking report, the deposits, and at least one outside check agree within a tolerance you set in advance.

Built for RV park revenue. For MHC lot rent, use its sibling: Rent-Roll Truth Check (AS-15). Pairs with AS-15.

The direction rule

Booked revenue excludes taxes. Shortfall explainers (deposits LOWER than booked revenue): cancels/refunds, comps, platform fees netted from payouts, timing, delinquency. Deposit inflators (strip before proven): collected taxes, advance deposits, security deposits, owner injections, loan proceeds, transfers. Ancillary income is a reclassification. Taxes and advance deposits ADD to deposits. They never explain a shortfall.

1. Sort the sites first

- Long-stay (monthly, seasonal, annual): use the MHC method, Rent-Roll Truth Check (AS-15).
- Transient (nightly, weekly): the month-by-month tie-out below.
- Park-owned rentals (cabins, park models, glamping): tie-out below, one row per unit type.

Mixed-park rule: most parks are mixed. Run long-stay sites through the MHC sheet and transient sites through this one. Never blend them into one occupancy number.

2. Get the raw export, run the report yourself

Work from the raw reservation export, not a PDF summary. Ask the seller to run it while you watch. No export is a flag. Redact guest names and payment details.

3. The 12-month tie-out

System net = booked revenue minus cancellations, refunds, and comped/staff/family nights. Compute it yourself from the raw export. (Lodging taxes and long-stay exemptions vary by state, confirm with your attorney).

Mo	System net	Bank deposits	Platform payouts	Taxes coll.	Advance dep.	Ties?	Power vs occ

4. Site-night math

Metric	Claimed	Proven
Site-nights available (sites x 365)		
Site-nights sold		
Occupancy (sold / available)		
Average daily rate, realized		
Revenue per available site-night		

Rack rate is the sticker price. Realized rate is what the money says after discounts and promos. Underwrite the realized rate.

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5. The reservation trace

Pick 20 reservations across months and channels; trace each from booking to folio to payout. Traced clean: ___ / 20. If 3 or more miss, double the sample to 40. If misses keep coming, treat the whole report as unverified.

6. The RV Gap Bridge

Claimed - cancels/refunds - comps - platform fees - timing + taxes + advance deposits = expected deposits. Expected - actual = unexplained.

Claimed ($): _____ **Cancels/refunds ($):** _____ **Comps ($):** _____

Platform fees ($): _____ **Taxes ($):** _____ **Advance deposits ($):** _____

Timing ($): _____ **Non-rent income ($):** _____ **Expected deposits ($):** _____

Actual deposits ($): _____ **Unexplained ($):** _____ **Threshold (%):** _____

Set the threshold before you start. Beat it and the deal pauses until the seller explains it in documents, not words.

Ancillary income, separated

Store, propane, laundry, firewood, storage, late/pet/extra-vehicle fees: verify each on its own. None of it is site revenue.

Ancillary source: _____ **Annual ($):** _____ **Verified how:** _____

7. The outside checks

- (a) Lodging and sales tax filings against booked revenue. Third-party-reported. Hard for the seller to shape.
- (b) Monthly electric, water, and trash volume against claimed occupancy by month. If occupancy jumps and the power bill does not, that is a finding.
- (c) Reviews and listing activity as a soft plausibility check on transient volume. Soft means soft: it suggests, it never proves.
- (d) The Mystery Shopper's ghost-occupancy drive-by (AS-04). Feet beat paper.

8. RV anomaly flags

- [ ] Annualizing peak months. A July number is not a year.
- [ ] Rack rate quoted as realized rate.
- [ ] Advance deposits for next season counted as this season.
- [ ] Bookings in the system with no matching money.
- [ ] Platform payouts that do not match gross bookings less fees.
- [ ] Owner, family, or staff stays priced as revenue.
- [ ] Heavy discounts (weekly, monthly, club, promo) hidden inside a healthy-looking ADR.
- [ ] Round-number deposits. Real folios are never round.
- [ ] Cash that never reaches the bank.
- [ ] Off-system bookings on paper.
- [ ] Long-stay sites marked occupied but paid in kind or not at all.
- [ ] Flat occupancy through months the park was closed or hit by weather.
- [ ] Seller will not run the raw export.

9. What the gap means and how to work it

Small gaps are timing and fees. Large or patterned gaps mean a different park than the one advertised. Take the pattern to your CPA and attorney, then reprice or walk. Never annualize a peak season. Price on 12 verified months.

10. The boundary with M4

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This tool proves the revenue happened. It does not turn proven revenue into a value.

Hand-off to RV Revenue Reality Check (AS-24): your 12 verified months, the seasonal shape, the realized ADR, and the separated ancillary income.

Worked example: Pine Hollow RV Park, fictional

Fictional. A 55-site RV park: 18 long-stay monthly sites, 37 transient sites. Claimed annual revenue $421,308. Twelve months of bank deposits $352,000. The arithmetic is shown so you can check every line.

The Gap Bridge

Bridge item	Amount ($)
Cancellations and refunds	8,400
Comped, staff, and family nights	3,100
Platform fees netted from payouts	9,600
Timing (December stays paid in January)	4,200
Shortfall items total	25,300
Collected taxes (ADD to deposits)	11,200
Advance deposits for next season (ADD to deposits)	7,800
Deposit inflators total	19,000
Ancillary income booked as site rent (reclassification, not an explanation)	2,500
Expected deposits	415,008

Expected deposits: 421,308 - 25,300 + 19,000 = $415,008. Unexplained: 415,008 - 352,000 = $63,008, which is 15.0% of claimed (63,008 / 421,308). The 3% pause threshold is 0.03 x 421,308 = $12,639. 15.0% beats 3%, so the deal PAUSES until the seller explains the rest in documents, not words. The raw gap was 421,308 - 352,000 = $69,308; the bridge nets $6,300 explained (69,308 - 63,008). This is a different park than the one advertised.

Money-proven revenue and the realized rate

Long-stay verified clean: 18 x 600 x 12 = $129,600. Deposits minus long-stay: 352,000 - 129,600 = $222,400. Proven transient earned revenue: 222,400 - 11,200 (taxes) - 7,800 (advance deposits) - 2,500 (ancillary) + 9,600 (platform fees added back) = $210,500.

Claimed transient nights sold: 37 x 365 x 0.45 = 6,077. Realized ADR: 210,500 / 6,077 = $34.64 against the $48 rack rate. Revenue per available site-night: claimed 291,708 / 13,505 = $21.60; proven 210,500 / 13,505 = $15.59. Method limit: the 6,077 nights come from the system export and are not yet proven, so the $34.64 realized ADR is a ceiling until the reservation trace confirms the nights.

The power finding: July shows 94% transient occupancy in the system, but the electric meter sits flat against June. High occupancy burns power. Flat power at 94% occupancy is a finding, and the July number pauses with the rest.

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The Doctrine

A booking report is a list of intentions. It records what guests planned to do, at prices the seller chose to show, in a system the seller controls. Revenue is what happened: money in the bank, payouts from platforms, taxes filed with the state, power burned on the lots. None of those can be edited after the fact, which is exactly why they are the check. The belief this tool shatters is that a busy-looking report is a performing park. The rule is one sentence: a month is verified only when the booking report, the deposits, and at least one outside check agree within a tolerance you set before you start. Everything else is a story about money, not money.

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